

Juan P. Aparicio

Applied Economist and Data Scientist | Political Economy | Research Reproducibility

PhD economist specializing in political economy, conflict, media, reproducibility, and applied data science.

Methods: applied microeconomics, causal inference, time-series and demand forecasting, survey data analysis, replication audits, human-AI evaluation.

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Google Scholar: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=ap4duGUAAAAJ&hl=en>

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Visiting Scholar, Centre for the Study of Existential Risk, University of Cambridge | May 2026.
- Visiting Scholar, Victoria University of Wellington | December 2025.
- Research Scientist (Postdoctoral Researcher), Institute for Replication, Ottawa, Canada | 2024-present. Organizes replication games and AI Games projects on human-AI interaction and research productivity; has led papers involving more than 700 replicators and contributed to projects involving more than 2,000 replicators, including work published in Nature, PNAS, Psychological Science, and Nature Human Behaviour.
- Fellow, CivicScience | 2024-present.
- Senior Economist & Senior Data Scientist, CivicScience, Pittsburgh, USA | 2022-2024. Developed demand-forecasting applications using CivicScience's real-time survey data and tested them with clients including McDonald's, Target, and Bank of America. The forecasting work later became a product line; continues as a CivicScience fellow and advisor.
- Postdoctoral Researcher & Senior Consultant, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín, Colombia | 2022-2023. Led EAFIT's consulting work with the Federación Nacional de Departamentos on liquor and cigarette smuggling in Colombia, resulting in the policy report listed below.

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

- AI-assisted teams outperform AI-led teams but not human-only teams in assessing research reproducibility in quantitative social science. With A. Brodeur, D. Valenta, A. Marcoci, D. Mikola, B. Barbarioli, et al. **Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences**, 123(22), e2524747123, 2026. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2524747123>.
- Captivating news: Media attention and FARC kidnappings. With Michael Jetter. **Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization**, 202, 69-81, 2022. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jebo.2022.07.029>.
- Internet Demand: The Colombian Telecommunications Wholesale Sector. With John J. Garcia. **Revista de Economía del Rosario**.

JOURNAL COMMENTS AND DISCUSSION PAPERS

- Peacefully Demobilizing Rebels: Identity, Emotional Cues, and the FARC. With Michael Jetter and Christopher Parsons. **IZA Discussion Paper No. 16054; job market paper**. <https://www.iza.org/en/publications/dp/16054/peacefully-demobilizing-rebels-identity-emotional-cues-and-the-farc>.
- Comment on "Telementoring and Homeschooling during School Closures: A Randomized Experiment in Rural Bangladesh" by Hassan et al. With Nikolai Cook, Derek Mikola, Ole Rogeberg, David Valenta, Michael Wiebe, Carl Bonander, and Abel Brodeur. **The Economic Journal**, 2026. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1093/ej/ueag040>.
- A Comment on "Delivering Remote Learning Using a Low-Tech Solution: Evidence from a Randomized Controlled Trial in Bangladesh". With Lenka Fiala, Derek Mikola, David Valenta, Michael Wiebe, Matthew D. Webb, Abel Brodeur, et al. **I4R Discussion Paper Series**, 2025. <https://ideas.repec.org/p/zbw/i4rdps/241.html>.

BOOKS AND POLICY REPORTS

- Estrategias anticontrabando y crimen organizado. EAFIT & Federación Nacional de Departamentos, 2023. <https://www.programaanticontrabando.com.co/pdfs/Estrategias%20anticontrabando%20y%20crimen%20organizado.pdf>.

WORKING PAPERS AND WORK IN PROGRESS

- The Wrong Snowball: Reintegration Signals and Demobilization in Colombia. With Verónica Abril. Working paper.
- You Speak, We Shoot: On the Unintended Consequences of Community Radios on Colombia's Violent Conflict. With Gustavo Canavire-Bacarreza and Eric Neumayer. Working paper.
- Violence and Migration: Analyzing the Mujahideen. Work in progress.
- Polarization in Democratic Elections: Insights from an Enhanced Hotelling's Model. Work in progress.

EDUCATION

- Ph.D. in Economics, University of Western Australia | 2023. Dean's list honorable mention.
- M.Sc. in Economics, Université catholique de Louvain | 2018.
- B.S. in Economics, Universidad EAFIT | 2016. Graduated with honors.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

- Research on Research initiative, I4R: USD 187,210.
- Sloan Foundation, I4R: USD 134,784.
- Dean's list, University of Western Australia.
- Postgraduate Award, University of Western Australia.
- Top Up Scholarship, University of Western Australia.
- Laureate Thesis, Universidad EAFIT.
- RTP Scholarship, Australian Government.
- Beca ICETEX, ICETEX.

TEACHING

- Advanced Topics in Econometrics, Universidad EAFIT | 2025.
- Introduction to Microeconomics, Universidad EIA | 2024.
- Introduction to the Colombian Economy, Universidad EIA | 2023.
- Intermediate Macroeconomics, Universidad EIA | 2023.
- Microeconomics Seminar, Universidad EAFIT | 2021-2023. Student evaluation: 4.8/5.
- Growth and Development, Universidad EAFIT | 2022. Student evaluation: 4.7/5.

SUPERVISION AND SERVICE

- Supervised or mentored students at Louvain School of Economics, Universidad EIA, and Universidad EAFIT.
- Referee service: Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences Nexus, Journal of Productivity Analysis, Sports Economics Review, Journal of the Operational Research Society, Migration Studies, Revista de Economía del Rosario.
- Pro bono consulting for International Justice Mission on violence against women and children in Colombia.

SKILLS

- Methods: applied microeconomics, causal inference, political economy, time-series and demand forecasting, replication audits, survey data analysis, human-AI evaluation.
- Software: R, Python, SQL, Stata, LaTeX, Excel.
- Languages: Spanish native; English C1; French and Portuguese basic reading comprehension with limited speaking proficiency.